RSE &Me

FREE LESSON

Relationships & sexuality education for autistic students · Universal Design Edition



UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.1

What consent means

What does it mean to ask, and to get a clear yes?

Full Six Steps lesson | Worksheet | Easy read | Note for home | Senior Cycle / LCA extension

Autism & Me
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Change the environment, not the child.

FREE SAMPLE

Welcome to your free sample lesson

This is one complete lesson from the **RSE Teaching Pack: Universal Design Edition**, a full year of relationships and sexuality education (RSE) for autistic students in Irish post-primary schools. Print it, teach it, and see how it works with your class.

What is in this sample

- A full lesson plan mapped to Junior Cycle SPHE (2023)
- Tricky questions and calm, honest answers
- A 40-minute Six Steps script with a "what to change" option for every step
- A one-page photocopiable worksheet
- An easy-read summary and a cut-out note for home
- A Senior Cycle / LCA extension task

How every lesson works

1 START	The goal is visible, not only spoken
2 TAKE IT IN	New information in more than one way
3 MAKE SENSE	Key words defined, literally
4 HAVE A GO	Clear task, known time, real choice
5 SHOW IT	Say, write, draw, point, sort or AAC
6 CHECK & CLOSE	Recap, question box, check-in

The one rule

A step is done only when the learner shows it landed. If it has not landed, change the environment, not the child: try once more, a different way.

The full pack: 24 lessons in 6 units

UNIT 1
My Body and Growing Up
1.1 · 1.2 · 1.3 · 1.4

UNIT 2
Public, Private and My Space
2.1 · 2.2 · 2.3 · 2.4

UNIT 3
Consent and Boundaries
3.1 · 3.2 · 3.3 · 3.4

UNIT 4
Friendships and Relationships
4.1 · 4.2 · 4.3 · 4.4

UNIT 5
Identity, Diversity and Sexual Health
5.1 · 5.2 · 5.3 · 5.4

UNIT 6
Online Life and Staying Safe
6.1 · 6.2 · 6.3 · 6.4

The full pack also includes a teacher guide (UDL and autism-informed practice, safeguarding and disclosures, Irish law at a glance, year plan, curriculum map) and photocopiables (class agreement, question slips, break cards, check-in scales, circles and safety network templates, record sheets, parent letter, glossary and Irish support services).

Before you teach this sample: read your school's RSE policy, check your Designated Liaison Person is available, and tell students in advance what the lesson is about. This lesson supports, and does not replace, your school's Child Safeguarding Statement and Children First procedures.

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UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.1

What consent means

What does it mean to ask, and to get a clear yes?

40 minutes

CURRICULUM LINKS

JC 3.7 Explore what consent is and how it is given and withdrawn (paraphrased)

JC 3.4 Describe and practise healthy boundaries in relationships (paraphrased)

Senior Cycle / LCA: Senior Cycle SPHE (NCCA) builds on this by applying consent to relationships, social media and the law; the LCA Social Education module can use it for personal-relationship and rights-and-responsibilities work.

LEARNING INTENTIONS

- We are learning what consent means.
- We are learning that consent is freely given, specific and can change.
- We are learning to notice everyday consent: hugs, borrowing things and photos.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- **I can say what consent means in my own words.**
- **I can name three things that make a yes a real yes.**
- **I can give one everyday example where I would ask first.**

KEY WORDS

consent	Saying yes to something, clearly, because you want to.
freely given	You say yes because you choose to. Nobody forces, tricks or pressures you.
specific	A yes is for one thing only. Yes to a hug is not yes to anything else.
withdraw	To change your answer and stop. You can do this at any time.
boundary	A line that shows what you are comfortable with.
permission	When someone says you may do something. It is another word for a yes.
pressure	Pushing someone to say yes. A yes under pressure is not a real yes.

MATERIALS

- Large visual: 'Consent is: freely given, specific, can change' on three cards (picture + words)
- Green, red and yellow response cards for each student (yes / no / I'm not sure)
- Slides or printed set of 6 everyday consent scenes (borrowing a pencil case, hug, photo, sitting on a bed, using someone's phone, sharing a snack)
- Lesson 3.1 worksheet, pencils, colouring pens
- Optional: a real pencil case and a phone for a model demonstration

PREPARE THE ENVIRONMENT

- Send the visual schedule home the day before and show it on the board: Start, Take it in, Make sense, Have a go, Show it, Check and close.
- Tell students in advance that this lesson uses everyday examples only (hugs, borrowing things, photos) and no one will be asked to share personal experiences.
- Provide an opt-out signal card (a small red card on each desk) that lets any student step to a quiet space without explaining.
- Use the same green, red and yellow response cards used across Unit 3 so students learn one system.
- Offer a seat near the door and allow headphones or fidget items throughout.

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Sensitivity and safeguarding. Some students may have had touch, photos or sharing done to them without being asked. Others may have never been asked their view. Keep examples everyday and neutral and do not ask for personal stories. If a student discloses something worrying, listen calmly, do not ask leading questions, do not promise confidentiality, and tell the DLP the same day. Remind the class that adults and teachers are always available.

Before you teach: tricky questions and calm answers

"What if someone says yes just to be polite?"

> That is a good question. A yes that is said because someone feels they have to is not a free yes. That is why we check and make it easy to say no. You can ask, 'Are you sure?' or 'It is fine if you want to say no.' If you are not sure someone wants to, treat it as a no.

"Do I need to ask my family before I hug them?"

> Asking first is a kind habit with everyone, including family. Many families already do it with a quick, 'Do you want a hug?' Everyone, including children and adults, is allowed to say no to a hug. Saying no is not rude. It is a boundary, and you can offer another way to show you care, like a wave or a high five.

"Why can someone say yes and then change their mind?"

> People can feel fine about something at first and then feel different. How they feel is the important part. Consent covers the moment, not the whole day. If someone says stop, we stop straight away. That keeps everyone safe and shows respect. It is the same when you change your own mind: you are allowed to.

EVIDENCE TO LOOK FOR

Look for: the student sorting examples correctly with a reason, shown by words, drawing, pointing or AAC; use of at least two key words (consent, freely given, specific, withdraw); naming one everyday situation where they would ask first. Non-verbal evidence includes card responses, pointing at the three parts, or picture matching. Note students who find it hard to separate pressure from a free yes for follow-up in 3.2.

The Six Steps · Lesson 3.1

1 START — 5 min

- Show the three goal cards on the board and read them aloud.
- Point to the visual schedule and tick off START.
- Hand out the response cards and practise: 'Show me green.' 'Show me red.'

Say: *Today we are learning what consent means. Consent means asking first and getting a clear yes. First I will show you the idea. Then we will sort examples. Then you will complete a worksheet. At the end you will tell me one thing you learned.*

Learner choices: Hold up a card to answer rather than speaking · Tell a partner the goal in your own words · Write or draw the goal on a sticky note

If it has not landed: put the three goal cards on each desk as a printed strip and let the student point to the one they find hardest to understand.

2 TAKE IT IN — 8 min

- Show the three-part picture: freely given, specific, can change, with a simple image for each.
- Act out a model: ask a student 'Can I borrow your pencil case?' and wait for a clear yes before taking it. Then repeat and show what happens when no answer comes: you do not take it.
- Show the 6 everyday scenes one at a time and read the caption aloud.

Say: *Consent is a clear yes that someone gives because they want to. It is freely given, so no pressure. It is specific, so it is for one thing only. It can change, so a person can say stop at any time. Watch how I ask, and how I wait for the answer.*

Learner choices: Watch the demonstration · Read the captions yourself · Look at the pictures only and match them to the three ideas

If it has not landed: replay the pencil case demonstration in slow steps with three still pictures (ask, wait, answer) and let the student move a counter along them.

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3 MAKE SENSE — 7 min

- Go through the key words with a picture beside each and read the meaning.
- Link to what students know: 'You already ask before using someone's charger or sitting at their seat.'
- Ask students to match each key word card with its meaning.

Say: *These words help us talk about consent. Consent is saying yes clearly. Withdraw means changing your answer. You already do consent in everyday life, like asking to borrow a rubber. Now we make sense of the words.*

Learner choices: Match word cards to meanings · Draw your own picture for one key word · Tell the teacher an example you already know

If it has not landed: give the student a word bank with pictures and sort just three words first (consent, pressure, withdraw), then add the rest.

4 HAVE A GO — 10 min

- Hand out the worksheet and read the instructions aloud. Say how long they have: ten minutes. Say they start with Part 1.
- Circulate. Prompt with 'What would you ask first?'
- Offer a partner, a quiet table or a scribe.

Say: *Your job is to sort each example into 'Real yes' or 'Not a real yes', then do the short tasks. Start with Part 1. You have ten minutes. You can work with a partner or on your own.*

Learner choices: Work alone, with a partner or with a scribe · Cut and sort the cards or tick the boxes · Use a colouring pen for green and red

If it has not landed: reduce the sort to four cards, put the first one done as a model, and let the student point to the answer instead of writing.

5 SHOW IT — 5 min

- Invite students to show one answer using their cards, drawing or words.
- Accept speaking, writing, pointing, AAC, typing or a drawing.
- Ask: 'Which of the three parts of consent is the most important to you today?'

Say: *Now show me what landed. Pick one example from your worksheet and show whether it is a real yes. You can say it, write it, draw it, type it or point to it.*

Learner choices: Say it to the class or to a partner · Draw a sign or picture · Type or use AAC · Point to a card on the board

If it has not landed: offer two options on cards ('real yes' / 'not a real yes') and let the student point, then add the 'why' with a word bank.

6 CHECK & CLOSE — 5 min

- Ask each student for one thing they learned.
- Tell them what comes next: Lesson 3.2 on asking clearly and reading the answer.
- Do the check-in: 'How did this lesson go for me?' using the green, yellow and red cards.

Say: *Today we learned that consent is a clear yes, freely given, for one thing, and that it can change. Next time we learn how to ask clearly. Now show me how this lesson went for you: green, yellow or red. You do not have to say why.*

Learner choices: Hold up a colour card · Write one word on a sticky note · Draw a face for how it went

If it has not landed: show a visual 'learned today' strip with the three consent parts and let the student tick the one they remember, or circle it in the worksheet.

Senior Cycle / LCA extension: Consent in everyday life and online

Write a short guide called 'Consent in Everyday Life' for younger students. Include at least four examples across different settings: school, home, friends, and online (for example, tagging someone in a photo or sharing a message). For each example, explain how to ask and what a clear yes sounds like. Then add one paragraph on why 'freely given' matters when a friend is persuading someone to say yes. Present it as a poster, short booklet or slide set.

LCA evidence: The guide could be used as evidence for an LCA Social Education key assignment on personal relationships and respect.

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Real yes or not a real yes?

Worksheet 3.1

Name: _____ Date: _____ I can answer by writing, drawing, pointing, sorting or using AAC.

Read each example. Decide if it is a real yes. Then finish Part 2 and Part 3.

Part 1: Sort these examples

Real yes	Not a real yes

✂ Cut out and sort, or draw a line, or write the letter in the box.

A. Aoife asks, 'Can I borrow your pen?' Cian says, 'Yes, go ahead.'

B. Seán says yes to a hug because his friend keeps asking and he feels bad.

C. Niamh says yes to a photo, then later says, 'Please delete it.' The photo is deleted.

D. Oisín does not answer. His friend takes his headphones anyway.

E. Precious says, 'Yes, you can have one of my crisps.'

F. Rían says yes to a hug today. He says no to a hug tomorrow, and his friend stops.

G. Jamal says 'okay' because his friend will be angry if he says no.

H. Ella nods and smiles, and her friend asks, 'Is that a yes?' Ella says, 'Yes.'

Part 2: Three parts of consent

Part	What it means in my words
Freely given	
Specific	
Can change	

Part 3: My everyday example

Write or draw one thing you would always ask before doing. It can be about hugs, borrowing or photos.

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Easy read: What consent means

1. Consent means saying yes to something.
2. A real yes is free. Nobody forces you.
3. A real yes is for one thing only.
4. You can change your mind.
5. You can say stop at any time.
6. Ask first. Wait for a clear answer.
7. If you do not get a yes, do not do it.
8. You are allowed to say no.

✂ cut and send home

A note for home · Lesson 3.1: What consent means

This week in SPHE we learned that consent means asking first and getting a clear, free yes, and that a person can change their mind. A small conversation starter: 'What do you like to be asked about before someone touches or borrows your things?' You can use everyday moments: ask before you hug, take a photo, or borrow their charger, and respect their answer. Seeing adults ask first teaches more than any lesson. There is no need to cover everything at once; short, calm chats work best.

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